

GUIDELINES– Categories of Stereotypes

Gender stereotypes are rigid and generalized beliefs about the roles, behaviors, abilities, or characteristics that men and women “should” have based on their sex or gender. These stereotypes are divided into several categories, each of which shapes social expectations, opportunities, and personal and professional relationships.

Each example must be assigned to only **one category**, even if multiple stereotypes appear in the same text.

Rule of thumb: if different categories of stereotypes appear in the same example, annotators should select the category that appears **first in the text**.

Example:

“Women are too emotional to be good leaders, and men should always provide for the family.”

→ This contains both a competence stereotype and a role stereotype, but since the competence stereotype appears first, it should be assigned to the “Competence” category.

NB: In the case of comments, it is important to consider whether the comment is relevant to the context.

- If someone comments on a woman’s physical appearance in a context where it is **irrelevant** (e.g., during a political speech), this is a stereotype.
 - If appearance is **contextually relevant** (e.g., a comment about a woman’s outfit in a fashion show), then it is **not** a stereotype.
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Role Stereotypes

Social and cultural expectations that define which family or social roles are “appropriate” for men and women. These concern what men and women “should do” and “should be.”

Note: work-related aspects are usually not considered here but rather in the “Competence” category.

- Men: breadwinners, heads of the household, responsible for financial support, protection, and family decisions.
- Women: mothers, housewives, responsible for child-rearing and domestic work.

Consequences:

- Lower acceptance of men who choose caregiving roles (e.g., stay-at-home fathers).
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Personality Stereotypes

Attributing emotional or character traits to men and women based on gender. This includes insults such as “fare la femminuccia” o “piangere come una femminuccia”, o “checca isterica”, “frocio”, “essere fighette” when talking about a man. The same applies to “avere le palle”, “donna con le palle” with women.

- Women: empathetic, sensitive, sweet, caring, emotional, indecisive, nurturing.
- Men: strong, assertive, authoritative, rational, confident, unemotional.

Consequences:

- Decisive women are perceived as aggressive.
 - Emotionally sensitive men are stigmatized.
 - “When women are on their period, they become irrational and angry.”
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Competence Stereotypes

Generalized judgments about professional, intellectual, or physical abilities based on gender. This includes skills in STEM, sports, or games such as chess.

- Women: suited for the humanities, supportive roles.
- Men: naturally skilled in science, logic, technology, and leadership.

Consequences:

- Discourages women from entering STEM careers.
 - Less trust in women’s competence in high-responsibility roles.
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Physical Stereotypes

Expectations related to the body, appearance, and self-care.

- Women: slim, young, attractive, well-groomed. Women are judged more harshly on beauty, thinness, and youth.
- Men: robust, scruffy, “acceptable as they are.” Men can age or be less groomed without facing the same stigmatization.

Consequences:

- Professional women are judged on appearance, which can affect careers.
 - Women’s looks are commented on even when irrelevant to the discussion.
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Sexual Stereotypes

Stereotypes about desire, sexuality, and sexual behavior. This includes insults toward women with sexual connotations (e.g., "puttana" o "zoccola"), which should always be categorized here, even when used as synonyms for "bitch." Insults such as "figlio/a di puttana" also fall into this category.

- Women: expected to be passive, pure, judged for sexual freedom, subjected to double standards.
- Men: active, "hunters," seen as naturally sexually driven.

Consequences:

- Women are hypersexualized or morally judged.
 - Men may feel pressured to display virility.
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Relational Stereotypes

Rigid models of how men and women should behave in interpersonal and romantic/sexual relationships, especially heterosexual ones. This includes judgments of women versus men in singlehood (e.g., "weird and repressed spinsters" Vs. "free bachelors").

It also includes stereotypes about relationships (e.g., women marry for financial advantage) or legal bias (e.g., laws protecting women are "unfair privileges").

- Women: caring, faithful, in need of protection, submissive, emotionally involved.
- Men: dominant, competitive, autonomous, emotionally detached.

Consequences:

- Limits women's autonomy and men's emotional expression.

Example Statements:

- [le donne] si sposano solo per i soldi sapendo che prima o poi ci sarà un divorzio milionario! Questa è la verità! Guarda caso i più ricchi al mondo sono tutti divorziati
- Come al solito la ex moglie voleva solo i suoi soldi poveretta che vergogna
- è proprio quello che fanno le donne, un vero e proprio casting. Ti basterebbe fare un profilo fake di un uomo medio su un'app incontri per capirlo. Se solo riesci a superare la prova "aspetto fisico" tra le numerose opzioni che una donna media ha quotidianamente (quando si iscrive su una di quelle app per lei è un supermercato) e una ti scrive o ti risponde inizia un vero e proprio colloquio di lavoro dove tu sei in competizione con un numero elevatissimo di contendenti.
- Basta una falsa mezza parola di una donna e un uomo perde tutto ancora prima di essere giudicato(poi se hai figli un padre li perde in automatico.. La giustizia...). Che mondo,si millanta la parità (giusta e sacrosanta) ma vogliono (femministe e false

donne) una sorta di. Parità fatta a modo loro con privilegi assistenzialismi e vittimismo.

- Ormai non si può nemmeno rivolgere parola ad una ragazza per il rischio di essere denunciati di catcalling... Vi hanno elevate ad esseri "superiori" e ancora parlate di movimenti femministi?